

Ellen Hill – CPSC 224 – Homework 1 : Farkle Summary

The intent of this project was to expose students to Java by translating a program from C++ into Java. We used Farkle, a luck based dice rolling numbers game, as the case for this. We were given the C++ application written by Professor Crandle to go off of, and I referenced it side by side while coding my Java application.

My coding style is to write the program all in main to ensure it works before breaking it up into classes, cleaning up main and keeping the project concise. Unfortunately, I never got to that part so my project is still in main (which is why you will not find any diagram attached).

The scoring loop gave me the most trouble, as it is a complex system of for loops and if statements. I was never able to get it to work, but am able to see the UI that is coded and the various numbers that are generated as dice. As I jokingly commented as I submitted it, “At least the people who decide they don’t want to play get what they want”. I also had no exposure to Java before this, so I spent a lot of time checking syntax and asking really dumb questions to people much more experienced than me.

If I’d had more time, I wish I could have gotten the project to work, and really understood why Professor Crandle build it the way they did. It seems overly complex, but then again maybe it needed to be. I would have liked to break up each of the mechanisms into classes so that main was clean and empty, and I would have liked to review the code for variables that are included in Crandle’s build and then never used.

I discussed with several of my classmates how long this project took them. Several of them said only an hour. If I had done this differently I’d wish to be those people who find this intuitive.